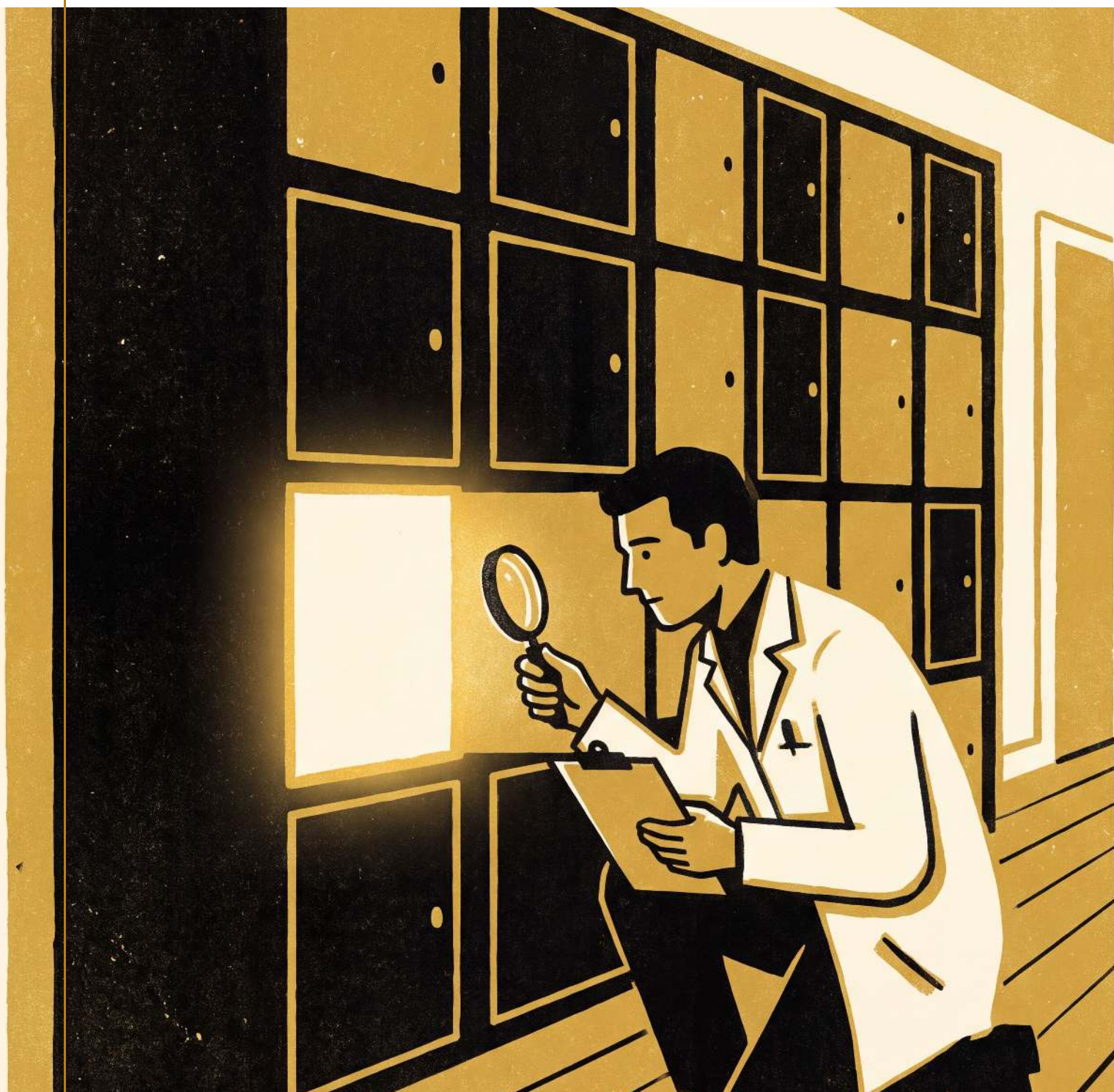




Slovenian / University

The Second Look

We check what everyone assumes is already checked.



Why Slop University

A parcel locker says a slot is held. A warehouse scanner says a pick was confident. A diagnostic colour group says a first-year student's table was sorted correctly in week one and can be trusted from then on. Behind each of these small, everyday certainties sits an assumption that somebody, at some point, checked — and that the checking still holds.

Slop University's business is going back and checking anyway. Not because the badge, the score, or the colour is usually wrong — most of the time it isn't — but because “usually” is exactly the gap a University built around measurement exists to close. The School of Emergent Priorities follows a claim of settledness forward in time to see how long it actually holds. The School of Continuous Improvement follows an instrument backward to what it was actually built to notice. Between them, the two schools have made a discipline out of the second look.

This brochure is an invitation to see that discipline at work — in a share house, a distribution centre, a first-year tutorial room — and to read, in full, what the second look actually found.



At a glance

Three things worth knowing before the second look.



Two schools, one instinct

The School of Emergent Priorities tests how long a settled claim stays settled; the School of Continuous Improvement tests what an instrument was actually built to notice. Different starting points, same destination.



Fieldwork, not the front office

Share houses, distribution centres, tutorial rooms: the checking happens wherever a badge, a score, or a flag is already quietly doing its job.



A record you can check yourself

Every finding carries a DOI on the University's own repository — the one claim in this brochure we'd rather you verified than trusted.

Our research

What a Confident Scanner Actually Knows

A warehouse's handheld scanner logs more than a barcode. Every pick carries a confidence score, quietly building the case that this order was assembled correctly and can move on to the next stage without a second look. The School of Continuous Improvement set out to ask what that confidence score was actually confident about. Dr Renke Sabel and Dr Joost Nwosu linked scanner logs from dozens of pickers across nine distribution centres to a blind, hand-conducted inventory audit run in parallel. The audit found the score's strongest relationship wasn't with the accuracy it was built to signal, but with how recently its picker had last sat through retraining — a schedule, not a shelf. Send a picker back through training and the score climbs obligingly; the error rate underneath it barely moves. The instrument was faithfully measuring something. It just wasn't the thing anyone downstream assumed.



A confidence score is only ever confident about whatever it was actually trained to notice. Ours had been trained to notice a training calendar.

— Dr Renke Sabel, Senior Lecturer and Convenor, Indicator Commons, School of Continuous Improvement

The Slot That's Held, Until It Isn't

A share house's parcel-locker bank makes one small promise to every resident: a slot marked held stays held for as long as the app says so. Dr Ronja Oyelaran and Dr Iben Chikere tested that promise directly, matching thousands of hold events across six share houses against the locker bank's own backend reassignment log over a full school term. Held is a stable word for most of the bank's life. It stops being one as the bank fills: reassignment happens faster the closer the bank sits to capacity, while the resident's own screen keeps reporting a slot as theirs for several minutes after someone else's parcel has already taken it. The promise holds exactly until the moment it's tested — which turns out to be precisely the moment residents most need it to.



The app doesn't lie to a resident, exactly. It just keeps talking for a few minutes after the bank has already made a different decision.

— Dr Ronja Oyelaran, Senior Lecturer, School of Emergent Priorities

The Colour That Wore Off

A first-year tutorial room sorts itself in week one: a short diagnostic, a table-colour assignment, and a quiet agreement that the placement is settled business from then on. Dr Lindiwe Achterberg and Dr Anouk Mensah followed a cohort of first-year students from that week-one sort through to a blinded week-nine result and found the colour's explanatory power fading across the term nearly as fast as it had been earned — while the reassignment flag built to catch exactly that drift almost never tripped. Nobody involved was wrong to sort the room in week one. The room, it turns out, keeps changing after the sorting stops.



A week-one placement is a fair guess about a room that doesn't yet exist. By week nine, the room has answered back, and the guess is still the one on file.

— Dr Lindiwe Achterberg, Lecturer, School of Emergent Priorities

Read the work

The pitch above draws on published work any reader can look up in full.

- **Reading the Score, Not the Shelf** — a warehouse scanner's pick-confidence score tracks a retraining calendar far more closely than it tracks the errors it exists to flag. [doi:10.5555/slop.sjdrdw](https://doi.org/10.5555/slop.sjdrdw)
- **Always Room, Except When There Isn't** — a share-house parcel locker's "held" badge outlives the slot it describes by several minutes, and the gap widens exactly when the bank is fullest. [doi:10.5555/slop.u2cxgn](https://doi.org/10.5555/slop.u2cxgn)
- **Sorted Once, Seated All Term** — a week-one diagnostic table-colour keeps its seat past week nine even as its power to explain anything quietly halves. [doi:10.5555/slop.jkkydn](https://doi.org/10.5555/slop.jkkydn)

Our people

Associate Professor Casimir Beng, Lead of the Adaptive Metrics Lab, School of Continuous Improvement, studies measurement systems that improve the things they measure — and, with equal interest, the systems that only look like they do.

Professor Verity Marris, Director of the Trajectory Analytics Group, School of Emergent Priorities, asks how a settled claim hardens into a fact nobody thinks to check again — the question the whole of this brochure has been quietly asking too.

Your next step

None of the checking above waited for a brochure to justify it, and reading the work doesn't require one either. The University's research repository holds each study in full, open access, every DOI resolvable on the University's own site rather than taken on faith — which is, after all, the entire pitch. Prospective students will find two schools that keep landing on the same instinct from opposite directions; prospective partners will find a University willing to point that instinct at whatever their own organisation already assumes is settled; and anyone who has ever trusted a badge, a score, or a flag a little further than it had earned is welcome to see what a second look actually finds.

Visit slop.university to read the work, meet the researchers behind it, and find out what your own settled certainties might not survive.



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